

SplitStack

Split Smart. Live Better.

BUSINESS PLAN

Intelligent Shared Budgeting & Expense Management

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Executive Summary

SplitStack is a next-generation shared budgeting and expense management platform designed to eliminate the friction, awkwardness, and financial stress that arises when people share costs — whether they are college roommates splitting rent, friends planning group travel, or families coordinating household budgets. By combining intuitive expense tracking with AI-powered insights, democratic voting mechanics, gamification, and optional blockchain-backed transparency, SplitStack delivers a seamless, trust-building experience that redefines how groups manage money together.

1.1 Business Concept

The core business concept of SplitStack is rooted in a single insight: **shared finances are a universal source of tension, and well-designed technology can resolve that tension elegantly.** Today's shared expense apps force users into rigid, manual workflows with minimal intelligence behind them. SplitStack flips the paradigm by making expense management collaborative, transparent, and genuinely enjoyable.

Users form groups — roommates, travel companions, or families — and manage money together within a single shared workspace. Every dollar spent is logged, visually split, and made visible to all members. A built-in voting system lets groups approve big-ticket purchases democratically, while an AI-powered assistant offers personalized financial nudges, answers questions in natural language, and proactively flags unnecessary subscriptions. Gamified challenges and progress rings keep users engaged and motivated long-term.

1.2 Target Market

SplitStack's primary audience is young adults aged 18–35 who regularly share living expenses or travel costs. This demographic is digitally native, socially connected, and increasingly conscious of personal financial health. Secondary segments include small families managing household budgets collaboratively and friend groups planning shared vacations or events.

Market Segments at a Glance

Primary: College students & young professionals (18–35) sharing housing or travel costs. **Secondary:** Young families and social groups coordinating shared purchases and budgets. **Geography:** North America initially, with global expansion planned for Year 2.

1.3 Proposed Solution

SplitStack is a **mobile-first SaaS application** that addresses every stage of the shared-expense lifecycle — from group creation to final settlement — within a single, polished interface. The platform integrates eight core capabilities that together create a holistic, intelligent financial companion for groups:

1	Group Management	Create and invite members to shared workspaces for roommates, trips, or households.
2	Expense Logging	Add expenses with automatic and manual split options, receipt scanning, and category tagging.
3	Visual Split Dashboard	Real-time interactive visualizations showing each member's balance and contributions at a glance.
4	Democratic Voting	A built-in approval workflow lets group members vote on big-ticket purchases before they are committed.

5	AI Roommate Chat	A conversational AI assistant that answers financial questions, offers advice, and surfaces insights proactively.
6	Challenges & Streaks	Gamified savings goals and accountability streaks to motivate healthy financial habits.
7	Subscription Flagging	Automated detection and alerts for redundant or underused subscriptions across the group.
8	Progress Rings	Beautifully animated visual indicators tracking individual and group financial goals in real time.

1.4 Team

The SplitStack founding team brings together deep expertise across product design, software engineering, AI/ML, and financial technology. Our lean, agile structure is designed to move fast while maintaining the engineering rigor required for a product handling sensitive financial data.

Role	Responsibilities	Key Skills
CEO / Co-Founder	Vision, strategy, fundraising, partnerships	Product strategy, business development
CTO / Co-Founder	Platform architecture, engineering leadership, AI roadmap	Full-stack dev, ML systems, cloud infra
Lead Designer	UX/UI design, design system, user research	Figma, user testing, mobile design
AI / ML Engineer	Chatbot dev, subscription detection, personalization	NLP, LLM fine-tuning, Python, TensorFlow
Marketing Lead	Go-to-market strategy, brand, user acquisition	Growth marketing, social, content strategy

Product Overview

SplitStack is architected as a modular, cloud-native platform built for scale, speed, and extensibility. Every feature has been designed with the user's daily workflow in mind — reducing friction at every touchpoint and replacing manual hassle with intelligent automation.

2.1 Core Features

Group Creation & Management

Users can create named groups in seconds — selecting a type (roommates, trip, household, or custom) and inviting members via email, SMS, or a shareable link. Group dashboards display a real-time summary of all activity, balances, and pending votes. Role-based permissions (owner, admin, member) provide flexibility and control.

Expense Logging & Splitting

Adding an expense is a three-tap flow: enter the amount, select a category, and choose how to split (equally, by percentage, or custom). The app supports receipt photo uploads with OCR-based auto-population of amounts and merchant names, reducing manual data entry to near zero.

Visual Split Dashboard

The dashboard is SplitStack's signature experience. Interactive charts and animated balance cards give every group member an instant, intuitive understanding of who owes what. Color-coded contribution bars, debt flow diagrams, and trend sparklines make financial transparency feel approachable rather than overwhelming.

Democratic Purchase Voting

For purchases above a configurable threshold, SplitStack initiates a group vote. Members receive a notification, review the proposed expense, and approve or decline — all within the app. The system tracks vote history and can auto-approve recurring approved items, reducing friction over time.

AI Roommate Assistant

The AI Roommate is a conversational financial companion powered by a fine-tuned large language model. It can answer questions like "Who owes the most this month?", suggest ways to reduce shared expenses, and proactively alert users to spending anomalies. The assistant learns from group patterns over time.

Challenges, Streaks & Progress Rings

Gamification is woven into the core experience. Users can join savings challenges, earn streak badges for consistent financial behavior, and watch animated progress rings fill as goals are met. These mechanics drive long-term retention and make financial discipline feel rewarding.

Subscription Flagging

SplitStack continuously monitors group spending patterns to detect and flag potentially redundant subscriptions — for example, if multiple members are paying for separate streaming services that could be shared. Alerts are surfaced with actionable suggestions.

2.2 Technology Stack

SplitStack is built on a modern, cloud-native architecture optimized for rapid development, horizontal scaling, and enterprise-grade security.

Layer	Technology Choices
Mobile Frontend	React Native (iOS & Android), Expo
Web Frontend	Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS
Backend / API	Node.js (Express / Fastify), REST & GraphQL
Database	PostgreSQL (primary), Redis (caching), MongoDB (logs)
AI / ML	Python, LangChain, OpenAI API, HuggingFace, scikit-learn
Cloud & DevOps	AWS (ECS, Lambda, S3, RDS), Docker, GitHub Actions CI/CD
Authentication	Auth0 / Firebase Auth, OAuth 2.0, JWT
Payments	Stripe Connect, Plaid (account linking)
Blockchain	Ethereum (Sepolia), Solidity smart contracts, Web3.js

2.3 AI-Specific Requirements

The AI layer is central to SplitStack’s differentiation and long-term competitive moat. The following requirements govern how AI capabilities are designed, deployed, and maintained:

- **Natural Language Understanding** — The AI Roommate must handle a wide range of user queries accurately, including ambiguous or colloquial phrasing. Integration with a capable LLM (e.g., GPT-4 via OpenAI API) and robust prompt engineering is required.
- **Context Awareness** — The assistant must maintain conversation context across multi-turn interactions and access the user’s live group data (balances, expenses, votes) for personalized responses.
- **Subscription Detection Model** — A lightweight classification model trained on labeled transaction data will run via a serverless endpoint to identify recurring charges that may be redundant or shareable.
- **Anomaly Detection** — A statistical or ML-based module will monitor group spending and surface alerts when spending deviates significantly from historical norms.
- **Privacy & Compliance** — All AI components must comply with GDPR and CCPA. User financial data will not be used for model training without explicit consent. AI outputs will be clearly labeled for transparency.
- **MLOps & Monitoring** — A pipeline using MLflow or AWS SageMaker will manage model versioning, A/B testing, and performance monitoring to ensure ongoing quality.

2.4 Blockchain-Specific Requirements

Blockchain integration serves a focused purpose: providing an optional, tamper-proof audit trail for group financial transactions — particularly valuable for high-stakes shared expenses such as group travel, shared property, or business partnerships.

- **Smart Contract Design** — A Solidity smart contract deployed on an Ethereum-compatible Layer 2 (Polygon or Arbitrum) will store cryptographic hashes of group transactions, enabling verification without exposing raw data on-chain.
- **Opt-In Architecture** — Blockchain verification is entirely optional. Users who prioritize trust can enable on-chain recording; those who do not experience zero performance or cost impact.
- **Gas Fee Abstraction** — Gas fees are abstracted using sponsored transactions or meta-transactions. Users never interact directly with gas mechanics.
- **Off-Chain / On-Chain Hybrid** — Raw transaction data remains off-chain in PostgreSQL. Only transaction hashes and group IDs are recorded on-chain, creating a verifiable but privacy-preserving audit trail.
- **Testnet-First Rollout** — Development and initial testing use the Ethereum Sepolia testnet. Production migrates to a cost-effective Layer 2 based on adoption benchmarks.

Market Analysis

3.1 Industry Overview

The shared expense and group finance market sits at the intersection of two high-growth verticals: personal finance technology (fintech) and social commerce. The global personal finance app market was valued at approximately **\$1.3 billion in 2023** and is projected to exceed **\$3.1 billion by 2028**, driven by increasing smartphone adoption, financial literacy awareness, and demand for proactive money-management tools.

Within this broader market, the "shared expense" niche is experiencing particularly rapid growth. The rise of the gig economy, increased co-living arrangements among millennials and Gen Z, and a surge in group travel post-pandemic have collectively created a large and underserved audience that needs smarter group financial tools.



3.2 Target Market & Competitive Analysis

SplitStack's target market is defined by three core user personas, each with distinct needs and pain points that our platform is purpose-built to address:

The College Roommate

Age 18–22. Splits rent, utilities, groceries, and shared household items. Pain points include tracking who paid for what, awkward money conversations, and lack of visibility into shared spending.

The Young Professional

Age 23–32. Lives with roommates or manages shared travel budgets. Wants automation, smart suggestions, and a clean mobile experience. Values financial intelligence and time savings.

The Social Planner

Age 25–35. Organizes group trips, events, or shared purchases. Needs democratic decision-making tools, clear cost breakdowns, and easy settlement flows.

Competitive Landscape

The competitive landscape includes several established players, but none offer the full spectrum of features SplitStack provides. Our key differentiators — AI-powered insights, gamification, voting mechanics, and blockchain optionality — create a unique positioning that competitors have not replicated:

Competitor	AI Chat	Voting	Gamification	Blockchain	Visual Dashboard
Splitwise	X	X	X	X	Basic
Venmo	X	X	X	X	Limited
PayPal	X	X	X	X	Limited

Competitor	AI Chat	Voting	Gamification	Blockchain	Visual Dashboard
Tricount	X	X	X	X	Basic
SplitStack	✓	✓	✓	✓	Advanced

Competitive Advantage

SplitStack is the only shared budgeting platform that combines **AI-powered financial coaching, democratic purchase approval, gamified engagement mechanics**, and **optional blockchain verification** into a single cohesive product. This combination creates a deep competitive moat that is difficult to replicate quickly.

Marketing & Sales Strategy

SplitStack's go-to-market strategy is built on a community-first, viral-by-design philosophy. Because our product inherently involves multiple people, every new user is a potential evangelist — and every group created is a natural acquisition channel.

4.1 Marketing Channels

We will deploy a multi-channel marketing approach, weighted toward digital and community channels that resonate strongly with our 18–35 target demographic:

Social Media Marketing

TikTok and Instagram Reels will be our primary organic channels. Short-form video content demonstrating real-world use cases — "How we split rent with zero arguments" — will drive awareness and shares. Paid social campaigns will amplify top-performing organic content.

Influencer Partnerships

Collaborations with personal finance micro-influencers (10K–100K followers) will provide credible third-party endorsements. We will prioritize creators whose audiences align tightly with our target personas.

Campus & Community Activation

On-campus ambassador programs at top universities will drive adoption among the college roommate segment. Partnerships with student housing platforms and co-living spaces provide direct access to high-intent users.

Content Marketing & SEO

A blog and resource hub targeting high-intent search queries like "how to split expenses with roommates" and "best budgeting apps for groups" will drive organic traffic and establish SplitStack as a category authority.

Referral & Word-of-Mouth

Built-in referral mechanics reward existing users for inviting friends into groups, creating a powerful viral loop that turns every active group into a growth engine.

4.2 Customer Acquisition

Our customer acquisition strategy leverages the inherently social nature of the product to achieve low customer acquisition costs (CAC) and high lifetime value (LTV):

- **Viral Group Invites** — When a user creates a group, every invited member is exposed to SplitStack organically. This network effect means each acquired user can generate multiple additional users at zero marginal cost.
- **Freemium Funnel** — A generous free tier (unlimited groups, core splitting features) lowers the barrier to entry. Premium features create natural upgrade triggers as groups grow and needs evolve.
- **Partnership Channels** — Integrations with platforms like Venmo, Apple Pay, and Google Pay reduce friction and expand distribution. Partnerships with student housing and travel platforms provide direct access to high-intent audiences.
- **App Store Optimization (ASO)** — Rigorous keyword targeting and A/B-tested creative assets in both the Apple App Store and Google Play Store will maximize organic discovery.

4.3 Growth Strategy & Monetization

SplitStack's monetization model is designed to align revenue generation with genuine user value. We pursue a **freemium + premium subscription** model, supplemented by transaction-based revenue for payment facilitation:

Revenue Stream	Description	Est. ARPU / Month
Free Tier	Core features: group creation, basic splitting, limited AI interactions	\$0.00
SplitStack Pro	Unlimited AI chat, advanced analytics, priority support, custom categories	\$4.99
SplitStack Team	All Pro features + blockchain verification, admin controls, group insights	\$9.99
Transaction Fees	0.5% fee on in-app settlement transactions (optional, user-initiated)	Variable
Enterprise / API	White-label or API access for student housing providers and travel platforms	Custom

Growth Roadmap

Phase 1 — Launch & Validate (Months 1–6)

MVP launch targeting college campuses in the US. Focus on core expense splitting, group management, and the AI Roommate chat. Validate product-market fit through user feedback loops and key engagement metrics.

Phase 2 — Scale & Monetize (Months 7–12)

Introduce Pro and Team subscription tiers. Expand campus ambassador program to 50+ universities. Launch paid social campaigns and influencer partnerships. Begin partnership discussions with student housing platforms.

Phase 3 — Expand & Diversify (Months 13–24)

International expansion into Canada, UK, and Australia. Launch blockchain verification feature for enterprise clients. Explore B2B white-label opportunities. Target Series A funding round based on demonstrated traction.

Long-Term Vision

SplitStack's long-term vision extends beyond expense splitting. We aim to become **the definitive platform for collaborative financial life** — where groups of people can not only split costs, but budget together, invest together, and achieve shared financial goals with the support of intelligent AI. By building trust through transparency, simplicity, and genuine financial insight, SplitStack will become an indispensable part of how the next generation manages money.